Job Description:
Kitchen Manager

Post Title: Kitchen Manager

Responsible to: Pub Manager

Responsible for: Kitchen Shift Leaders and Student Staff

Grade: Guild Grade D

Organisation:

This role is part of the Venues department which works collectively with colleagues to deliver the Guild's Food & Beverage operations including, Joe's Bar (J D Wetherspoon pub), nightclub operations and event security within the Venues Department, within the Engagement Directorate.

Job Purpose:

The Kitchen Manager role is to supervise, develop and support staff to deliver the Venues departmental plan. Acting as a role model for the required standard of values, behaviour and performance, we expect managers to create an inclusive and engaging environment for all.

The role is required:

- To take responsibility for the efficient and cost-effective operation of the kitchen, including stock control, food safety, team development and the achievement of kitchen financial targets, contributing to an excellent experience for students and customers
- To support, lead, motivate and develop the kitchen team, in a safe happy environment
- To adhere to quality, cleanliness, safety and operational performance (CQSMA), ensuring that all food is prepared to specification and that the kitchen remains clean, safe and compliant throughout trading.

Success in the role will require a highly student and customer focused approach together with an emphasis on teamwork. The role involves collaboration with internal and external stakeholders, acting as a positive ambassador for the Guild and facilitating under-represented groups to find a comfortable place here.

Supporting a culture of ambitious targets and a positive team spirit are also key. The Kitchen Manager is expected to follow the Guild's competency framework, which should be read in conjunction with this job description.

Key Role Responsibilities:

1. To work with the Pub Manager and the Business Development Manager to ensure the (JD Wetherspoons) JDW food operation is profitable and meets franchise standards and compliance targets.

2. To lead the kitchen operation to deliver safe, efficient and effective service to JDW and Guild standards.

3. To deliver consistently high CQSMA standards in the kitchen, proactively managing results which fall below expectations.

4. To ensure the kitchen opening and closing procedures are adhered to.

5. To prepare, cook and present all food to JDW and Guild standards, achieving food delivery time targets at all times.

6. To be aware of and knowledgeable about, all promotions events and new products within JDW, sharing your knowledge with the kitchen team to ensure they have the latest information.

7. To take pride in maintaining the highest standards of cleanliness by adopting our clean-as-you-go philosophy for all areas,

8. To ensure that the kitchen is cleaned and maintained in accordance with guidelines throughout the day, ensuring the kitchen team action any points raised on kitchen checks in a timely manner.

9. To respond to any customer feedback in a positive and helpful manner, seeking support if required, reviewing all customer feedback with the Pub Manager and identifying / actioning any training needs.

10. To recruit, induct, schedule, coach and performance-manage the Kitchen team ensuring training is completed to standard and within agreed time frames.

11. To maintain office administration in line with Guild / JDW policies including data Protection.

12. To use systems including kitchen screen reporting system, JDW and Guild systems.

13. To ensure all training materials and kitchen documents are up to date and displayed correctly.

14. To work with the Pub Manager to forecast sales and associated costs, review and manage aspects of the profit and loss account and maximise sales opportunities.

15. To manage stock holdings and minimise shrinkage, monitoring correct portion control, appropriate order levels and receive deliveries

16. To complete daily line checks and log all wastage, overseeing the completion of managers own stock (MOS) introducing and managing any actions for improvement

17. To maintain five-star food hygiene standards and support Environmental Health Officer (EHO) visits as required.

18. To monitor kitchen equipment, report faults promptly and liaise with contractors to minimise downtime and maintain operational readiness.

19. To read and action the JDW management action pack, operational documentation and relevant briefs; participate in monthly review processes as required.

20. To ensure compliance with all JDW and Guild kitchen-related policies and legal requirements, including SOPs, food safety, health and safety (COSHH, fire checks), EDI and anti-harassment obligations.

21. To identify opportunities to improve kitchen quality, speed, consistency or cost through evidence-led process improvements, recommending changes to the Pub Manager for consideration.

22. To actively look for ways to work smarter and to identify improvements, such as efficiencies or service enhancements through research and other evidence sources, and to recommend these to the Pub Manager for consideration.

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23. To develop and maintain effective working relationships key internal and external stakeholders.

24. To affiliate to relevant bodies and establish a network of contacts and related service providers at local, regional and national levels, as necessary.

General Duties:

1. To undertake appropriate induction and ongoing training and personal development, as required for the role.

2. To adhere to all Guild & JDW policy with reference to HR, staffing, health and safety, data protection, environmental and any other specific Guild Policy which impacts upon your role or that of the team.

3. To be familiar with the Guild's competency framework, striving always to demonstrate the positive behaviours which drive the highest standards of personal and organisational performance in supporting our students. As People managers, Grade D staff should be developing within level 2 of the six competencies (Student and Customer Focus, Accountability, Results Focus, Inclusivity, Communication and Teamwork) and within level 1 of the 'Motivational Leadership' competency, which is designed to support staff to achieve high performance.

4. To act as a role model in portraying a positive image of the Guild both internally and externally, acting as an ambassador and displaying high standards of personal integrity and professionalism.

5. To support the Pub Manager and the wider work of the department where necessary, in the event of sickness, holiday or other exceptional circumstances.

6. To undertake such other duties as may be reasonably required, consistent with the nature and grade of the post.

March 2026

Person Specification: Kitchen Manager

You must be able to demonstrate in your application that you have;

	Essential	Desirable
QUALIFICATIONS		
Good general education, typically to degree standard or equivalent, including Math's and English at least to GSCE C or equivalent	✓	
Food Safety level 3	✓	
Level 3 Supervising Food Safety qualification	✓	
Have a Personal Licence qualification	✓	
Management / Leadership training or qualification such as the JDW management academy		✓
KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE		
Experience working in a fast-paced commercial kitchen environment, delivering food to specification and time targets	✓	
Experience of managing or supervising a kitchen team to achieve service standards	✓	
Knowledge of food safety legislation, COSHH, HACCP, allergens, and maintaining a 5-star hygiene rating	✓	
Experience of kitchen stock control: portion control, wastage logging, ordering, deliveries and stock check	✓	
Experience completing or contributing to stock audits and implementing corrective actions	✓	
Experience supporting kitchen financial performance (labour, waste, yield, controllable costs)	✓	
Experience of maintaining kitchen documentation, compliance records and GDPR-aligned paperwork	✓	
Experience collaborating with wider venue teams (front-of-house, management, maintenance)		✓
Experience working within branded or franchise food operations (JDW style)		✓
SKILLS AND ABILITIES		

Ability to lead, coach and motivate and develop others, supporting and training new and progressing kitchen team members	✓	
Attend and participate in regular team meetings, manager meetings and training sessions	✓	
Ability to maintain high kitchen standards (CQSMA), including SBAL checks and clean-as-you-go compliance	✓	
Ability to generate and share ideas for improvements in the Kitchen	✓	
Ability to plan, prioritise, stay calm and manage multiple tasks during high-volume service periods	✓	
Strong understanding of food preparation, cooking processes and portion control	✓	
Ability to maintain accurate kitchen records and use JDW kitchen reporting systems	✓	
Ability to recognise customer feedback trends and respond constructively	✓	
Ability to present information clearly and concisely in writing or verbally, including effective team briefings, with excellent standards of written and spoken English	✓	
Good IT skills including proficiency in Microsoft Office including digital systems	✓	
Have a strong work ethic and be self-motivated	✓	
Ability to work collaboratively with the Pub Manager and follow organisational processes	✓	
Ability to support the achievement of the departmental action plan.	✓	
PERSONAL QUALITIES		
Motivated by working in a student-led, democratic workplace	✓	
Inclusivity - celebrates and supports equality and diversity and acts as a role model in creating a welcoming and inclusive environment	✓	
Student & Customer Focus: Highly responsive to students' issues and concerns, and driven to improve service delivery	✓	
Teamwork: Open and approachable - able to engage students and colleagues at all levels	✓	
Results Focus: Flexible approach - able to modify plans to achieve the best outcome	✓	
Results Focus: Resilient – can maintain direction and support colleagues in difficult situations	✓	

Motivational Leadership: Inspires, coaches and supports people to achieve their best	✓	
Accountability: Attention to detail, follows-up on actions and opportunities to improve	✓	
Communication: Able to present a case confidently and persuasively	✓	